

8.2 A Web Server On Your Home Computer!

Before looking at the content management systems, let us look at some software packages that help us to run these scripts on our computers. Suppose you own a small business and have developed a Web site for it using a CMS. Before uploading it to your server and launching it, wouldn't you want to test your Web site? As in software development, bugs tend to crop up no matter how hard you try ironing them out. So, wouldn't you want to test your Web site thoroughly before uploading it? Besides, uploading files again and again is time consuming.

There are various applications available to help you install and run the required software necessary for running a Web server right on your computer. All this without *any* prior knowledge required! So, if you own a business and don't quite understand what Apache, MySQL or PHP mean, don't worry. Software packages such as EasyPHP and XAMPP are specifically developed for this very purpose.

8.2.1 EasyPHP

EasyPHP, like XAMPP, is a software package that installs Apache, MySQL and PHP on your computer, so that you can test and run all your PHP-based Web sites without uploading it to a Web server. Apache is an extremely successful open source Web server. MySQL is an open source database system that's been adopted at large by the Web hosting community.

8.2.1.1 Installation

Installing EasyPHP is *relatively* simple. All you need to do is download the software from their site (www.easyphp.org) and install it. After installing EasyPHP, launch EasyPHP from Start > Program Files > EasyPHP

The program will launch and will automatically start Apache as well as MySQL. Open your favourite browser and go to <http://localhost> or <http://127.0.0.1>, and if all is well, you will get a